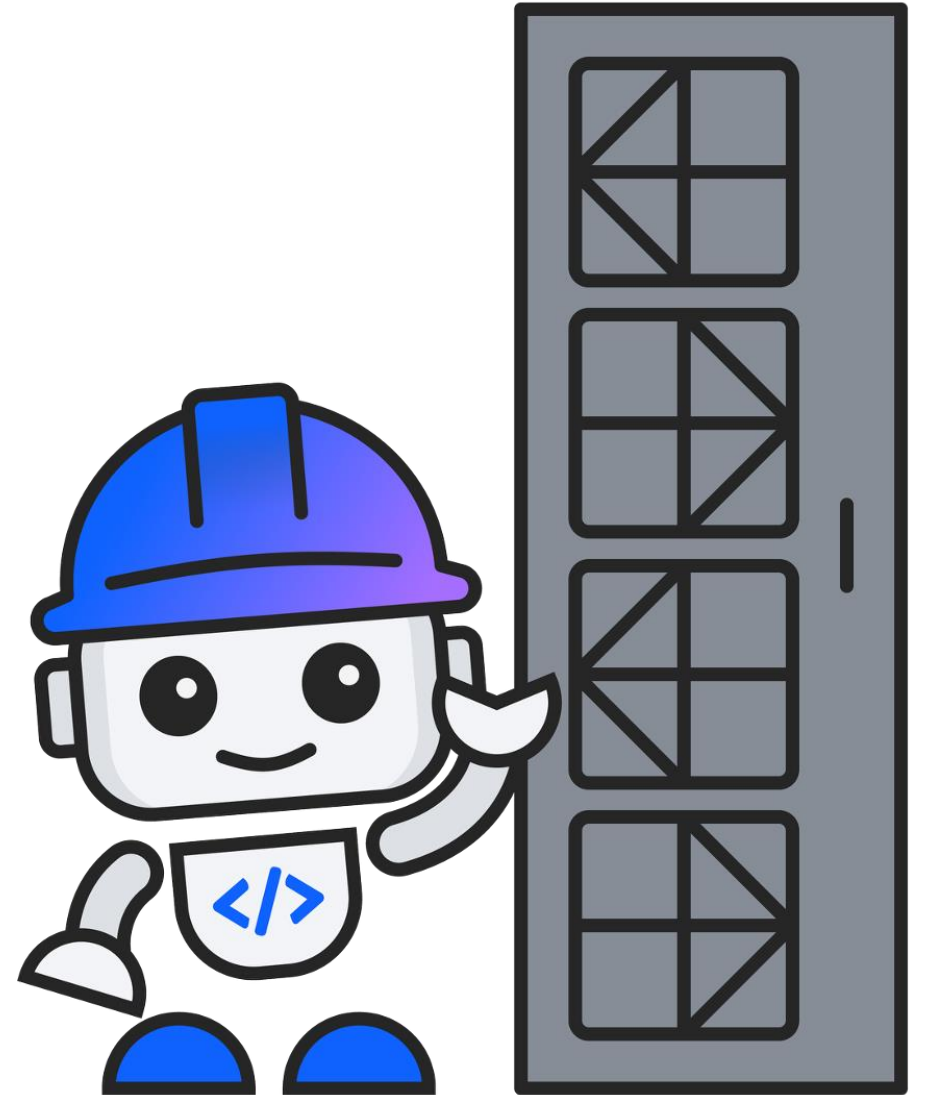




Bobathon for Z

CE Planning Guide

Everything you need to plan and run
a successful Bobathon for Z with your client.



What is a Bobathon for Z?

A structured 1-day hands-on workshop — part of the IBM CE engagement model:

The Bobathon sits in the middle — hands-on enablement that builds proof and momentum toward a pilot.

Custom Demo	Bob-a-Thon	Pilot
IBM CE builds a tailored demo Uses client's own code & scenarios Integrated with client toolchain Goal: prove Bob works for your stack	1-day hands-on workshop Developers + Client Engineers Guided labs + open experimentation Outcome: functional prototype	Weekly office hours Executive playbacks Business value KPI tracking Quote / proposal based on BVA

How the Labs Work

Labs 1 and 2 are always required. Labs 3–6 are choose-your-own-adventure.

Half-day: Labs 1 + 2 + one adventure lab. Full day: Labs 1 + 2 + two or more adventure labs.

ALWAYS REQUIRED

Lab 1	Getting Started Workspace scan · Agent.md · Data Dictionary ~20 min	Lab 2	Technical Design Doc Architecture docs · Business rules in plain English ~15 min
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▼ then pick any of:

CHOOSE YOUR ADVENTURE

Lab 3	Lab 4	Lab 5	Lab 6
Impact Analysis ~30 min	Refactoring & Services ~60 min	Spec-Driven Code Gen ~45 min	UI Modernization ~45 min

Key Decisions Before You Start

Work through these before scoping the event with your client.

Sample Code or Customer Code?

Will attendees use GenApp (provided) or bring their own COBOL workspace? If using customer code or custom use cases, allow minimum 3 weeks — SME time is needed to build and curate content.

Who Are the Participants?

Hands-on mainframe developers / SAs, or managers? This drives which labs are appropriate and the depth of technical content.

How Many People?

Ideal: 4–12 developers. More than 15 requires additional CE support. Plan environment provisioning based on headcount.

How Long Is the Event?

All 6 labs = ~3–4 hours of lab time, not including presentations or debrief. Half-day: Labs 1 + 2 + one adventure lab.

What Is the Modernization Goal?

Documentation, refactoring, UI modernization, or new code generation? Use this to select which adventure labs (4–6) to run.

Lead Time — Plan Ahead

Minimum 1 week to provision the pp4z instance for GenApp. If using client code or custom use cases, allow at least 3 weeks.

Environment Options

Choose the setup path that fits your client's IT constraints.

RECOMMENDED

AIR-GAPPED

ZERO CLIENT SETUP

IBM Cloud Account

Pros

- No software install required
- Attendees create a free IBM Cloud account
- Bob Premium accessed via cloud
- Best for: most enterprise clients
- Setup time: ~10 minutes

Cons

- Requires internet access
- Cloud account approval may be needed

Pre-Configured VM

Pros

- CE provides ready-to-use VM image
- No client install permissions needed
- Bob + VS Code + GenApp pre-loaded
- Best for: restricted/regulated environments

Cons

- VM distribution logistics
- Hardware requirements for attendees

CE-Provided Laptops

Pros

- IBM CE brings laptops pre-loaded with VM
- Attendees use CE hardware on the day
- No client machine or install required
- Best for: strict IT / no BYOD environments

Cons

- Limited quantity — plan headcount early
- Coordinate with CE well in advance

Top Questions to Ask the Client

Code & Codebase

Sample Application (GenApp)

- ☐ Are you using our provided GenApp sample?
- ☐ Do your use cases require different sample code ex .asm?

Best Scenario:

No extra source prep needed — all labs are pre-tested against GenApp

Client / Customer Code

- ☐ Is source code accessible in VS Code on the day?
- ☐ How large is the codebase? (# of programs / copybooks)
*There are size limitations in the local scanners used for Bobathons.
- ☐ Is the code COBOL, PL/I, HLASM, or a mix?
- ☐ Allow 3+ weeks lead time — SME needed to curate content

Scope & Goals

- ☐ What is your #1 modernization priority right now?
- ☐ Are CICS and DB2 in scope for this event?
- ☐ Is UI modernization a goal, or backend analysis only?

Environment & Prerequisites

- ☐ Do attendees have admin rights to install Java, Bob, and potentially Maven?
- ☐ Can they create an IBM Cloud account, or is that blocked?
- ☐ Any air-gapped or no-internet restrictions?
- ☐ Java 21 pre-installed — any org-approved distribution is fine.

Team & Constraints

- ☐ Is a COBOL expert or z team member available on the day?
- ☐ What is the COBOL experience level of attendees?
- ☐ Are there AI tool usage policies or approval requirements?
- ☐ Who is the executive sponsor and what are their KPIs?

Lab Reference – At a Glance

One row per lab. Use this as a quick reference when planning which labs to run.

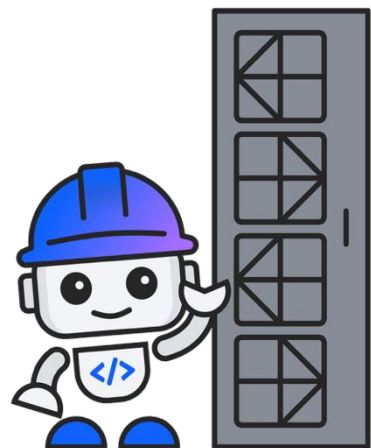
Lab	Title	Mode	Duration	Difficulty	Description
1	Getting Started	Z Architect	15–20 min	Beginner	Scan the workspace, initialise Agent.md, and generate the Data Dictionary. Must run first — every other lab depends on this.
2	Technical Design Doc	Z Architect	10–15 min	Beginner	Generate a full technical design document with plain-English business rules and Mermaid architecture diagrams.
3	Impact Analysis	Z Architect → Z Code	30 min	Beginner	Identify all programs affected by a field change, produce a risk-ranked rollout plan, and implement updates automatically.
4	Refactoring & Services	Z Code	60 min	Intermediate	Extract shared validation logic from a monolithic COBOL program into a reusable CICS LINK service program.
5	Spec-Driven Code Gen	Z Architect → Z Code	45 min	Intermediate	Derive coding standards from the existing codebase, then generate a complete CICS COBOL program from a plain-English spec.
6	UI Modernization	Z Architect → Z Code	45 min	Intermediate	Analyse CICS BMS maps, generate a React/Angular frontend + Spring Boot backend, and run the app locally.

Using GenApp – The Sample Application

GenApp is the fastest path to a Bobathon – pre-tested against all 6 labs, no setup surprises, ideal for first-time events.

Why use GenApp

- Known-good – all labs are tested and verified against GenApp
- Full CICS + DB2 + COBOL stack – covers every use case
- Program naming is clean and consistent (LG-prefix)
- Scan always succeeds – outputs are predictable
- Provided as .zip – extract and open folder in Bob



Key Programs (LG-prefix convention)

LGDPDB01	Policy Delete – DB2 operations
LGAPDB01	Policy Add – DB2 operations
LGUPDB01	Policy Update – DB2 operations
LGIPDB01	Policy Inquiry – DB2 operations
LGACDB01	Account – DB2 operations
LGUCDB01	Customer Update
LGICUS01	Customer Inquiry
LGPOLVAL	Policy Validation Service (extracted)
LGERROR	Error Logging Service
LGRENPOL	Renewal Policy (spec-driven example)

CE Tips & Planning Prerequisites

Confirm these before you commit to a date with the client.

Lead Time — Minimum 1 Week (GenApp)

Provisioning a pp4z instance takes at least 1 week. If using GenApp and standard labs, start the request immediately after scoping. Do not commit to a date until this is confirmed.

Custom Content or Client Code — 3+ Weeks

If the client wants their own code or custom use cases, an SME must build and curate that content before the event. Allow a minimum of 3 weeks for this preparation.

Java 21 Must Be Pre-Installed

Attendees must have Java 21 installed before the event. They do not need the IBM distribution — any Java 21 version approved through their organisation's standard software assets is fine. Confirm this with the client IT contact in advance.

COBOL Expert on the Day

Ensure a COBOL expert or z team member is present to support attendees. They unblock questions that Bob cannot answer about proprietary code patterns or system-specific behaviour.

What the Day Looks Like

A structured day of guided labs, hands-on experimentation, and real outputs.

